



Department of Economics
COLLEGE OF LETTERS & SCIENCE
UNIVERSITY OF WISCONSIN-MADISON

Course Syllabus

Econ 302: Macroeconomics (Fall 2026)

Mondays and Wednesdays 2:30-3:45pm, Ingraham B10

Weekly Discussions meet Fridays at scheduled times

Course website: <https://canvas.wisc.edu/>

Instructor

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Teaching Assistants

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Office Hours

See Module 0 of the course website.

Course Description and Prerequisites

Principles and theories of national income determination, analysis of savings, consumption, investment and other aggregates in the national and international economy and relation to employment, inflation and stabilization.

Prerequisites: [MATH 211](#), [217](#), [221](#), or [275](#) and ([ECON 101](#) and [102](#)) or ([A A E 215](#) and [ECON 102](#)) or [ECON 111](#). Not open to students with credit for [ECON 312](#)

Note: Econ 302 does not meet the requirements for the Honors Econ major; Students pursuing the Econ Honors major must instead take Econ 312.



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Learning Outcomes

Students will deepen their understanding of the behavioral relationships that affect macro-economic behavior and develop tools to develop and test economic models designed to forecast and analyze the effects of changing economic conditions and policy proposals using the Scientific Method.

Course Material

- Textbook: Included with registration
 - Macroeconomics, Williamson, 6th edition
- Canvas:
 - Access to e-text
 - Lecture notes, chapter notes, and supplemental reading
 - Quiz and Exam information
 - Access to online exams

Credits and Time Commitment

The credit standard for this 4-credit course is met by an expectation of a total of 180 hours of student engagement with the course's learning activities (with a University-wide expectation of at least 45 hours per credit). Student engagement includes attending lectures and participating in "Ask Your Neighbor" exercises, actively participating in weekly discussion section meetings, doing the assigned reading, problem sets, as well as exam prep and exam work (for details see elsewhere in this syllabus).

Learning Methods

Expect regular, substantive student-instructor and student-student interaction in this course.

- Lectures will meet face-to-face and include frequent breaks for “Ask Your Neighbor” student-student interaction that is then shared out both to the instructor and to the class as a whole.
- Discussion sections will meet face-to-face and consist of TA presentations and groupwork with a focus on exam and quiz preparation.

New material is introduced during lecture. The textbook reinforces concepts from the lectures, using the same notation and definitions. Discussion work consists of practice problems, groupwork, and clarification of material from lecture.

Lists of potential quiz questions are given at the start of each Module. Quizzes will draw exclusively from these lists. Exams will derive at least half their points from these lists, with other points testing the same material but in different wording/formats.

Canvas Problem Sets further reinforce concepts from lecture, discussion, and the readings. Canvas Problem Sets are excellent exam preparation but are not required. Feedback for wrong (and often also for correct) answers is automatically provided in order to enhance the learning experience from the online digital learning platform.

Old paper exams and practice online exams are available in Canvas Course Modules for help with exam preparation. End-of-chapter questions from the textbook are also available for additional practice; a list of recommended end-of-chapter questions is available on Canvas, along with answer keys.



Course Requirements

Lecture:

- Exams will draw heavily from Lecture and Discussion material. Information in the textbook that is not also covered in lecture will not be tested on the exams even if that material is covered in the optional “practice” problem sets or on old exams.

Discussion: Quiz dates

- ***Quizzes are given online, face-to-face***, proctored by Honorlock and your webcam in 5 of the Discussion meetings.
- Canvas will drop the lowest 2 of 5 quiz scores.
- No books or notes or outside material are permitted. You must use a calculator that is on your computer. If you are found using either an external device or an online calculator you will receive a zero on the quiz.
- **All potential quiz questions (and answers) are given in advance**
- If any test-taking conditions are violated, the student will receive a zero; a zero earned in this way cannot be dropped as a “lowest” quiz score

Discussion: Non-quiz dates

- Canvas will drop your 2 lowest Discussion scores
- Discussion attendance, participation, and notetaking) is graded weekly according to the following rubric:
 - 1 point: Attendance
 - 1 point: Active groupwork Participation throughout the entire section meeting
 - 1 point: Serious handwritten discussion notetaking shown to the TA

Exams:

- ***Exams are given online, face-to face***, proctored by Honorlock and your webcam in 3 of the lectures and during the scheduled final exam slot
- Canvas will drop the lowest of each student’s 4 exam scores
- No books or notes or outside material are allowed during exams. You must use a calculator that is on your computer. If you are found using either an external device or an online calculator you will receive a zero on the exam.
- **At least 50% of the points on each Exam will come word-for-word from that Module’s posted list(s) of potential quiz questions**
- If any test-taking conditions are violated, the student will receive a zero; a zero earned in this way cannot be dropped as a “lowest” exam score

Assessment

I don't assign letter-grades to individual assignments. Based on recent averages and standard deviations, I expect to have the following course letter-grade cut-offs—I will update later in the course if I expect to lower the cutoffs for letter grades, but I will not under any circumstances make the cutoffs “harder” than the ones posted here:

93-100	A
88-92.99	AB
83-87.99	B
78-82.99	BC
70-77.99	C
60-69.99	D
<60	F

The course total is calculated using the following weighting scheme, with the expectation that nearly everyone in the class will get a perfect score on both the Problem Sets and Discussion Attendance, Preparation, and Participation.

Course weights:

60%: Best 3 of 4 Exam scores

30%: Best 3 of 5 Quiz scores

10%: Discussion Attendance, Participation, and Notetaking on non-quiz days

- Best 5 of 7 scores
- Discussions can be made up by attending 50 minutes of office hours within a week of the missed date: Let either Dr Eudey or the TA know you are attending for that reason.

There are no extra credit options in this class and no extensions for busy schedules or trips.

Assessment Schedule*

Friday, September 25: 30-minute Chapter 1-4 Quiz given in/during discussion

Friday, October 9: 30-minute Chapter 5 Quiz give in/during discussion

- Monday, October 12: 60-minute Chapter 1-5 Exam given in/during lecture

Friday, October 30: 30-minute Chapter 6 Quiz given in/during discussion

Friday, November 13: 30-minute Chapter 7-8 Quiz given in/during discussion

- Monday, November 16: 60-minute Chapter 6-8 Exam given in/during lecture

Friday, December 4: 30-minute Chapter 9-10 Quiz given in/during discussion

- Monday, December 7: 60-minute Chapter 9-10 Exam given in/during lecture

Wednesday, December 9: in-class review for the cumulative final exam

- Friday, December 11: 60-minute cumulative final exam given 2:45pm in the scheduled exam slot

*Barring unforeseeable events like weather disruptions that may impact the schedule

Misconduct Statement

Academic Integrity is critical to maintaining fair and knowledge based learning at UW Madison. Academic dishonesty is a serious violation: it undermines the bonds of trust and honesty between members of our academic community, degrades the value of your degree and defrauds those who may eventually depend upon your knowledge and integrity.

Examples of academic misconduct include, but are not limited to: cheating on an examination (copying from another student's paper, referring to materials on the exam other than those explicitly permitted, continuing to work on an exam after the time has expired, turning in an exam for regrading after making changes to the exam), copying the homework of someone else, submitting for credit work done by someone else, stealing examinations or course materials, tampering with the grade records or with another student's work, or knowingly and intentionally assisting another student in any of the above. Students are reminded that online sources, including anonymous or unattributed ones like Wikipedia, still need to be cited like any other source; and copying from any source without attribution is considered plagiarism.

The Dept. of Economics will deal with these offenses harshly following [UWS14 procedures](#):

1. The penalty for misconduct in most cases will be removal from the course and a failing grade,
2. The department will inform the Dean of Students as required and additional sanctions may be applied.
3. The department will keep an internal record of misconduct incidents. This information will be made available to teaching faculty writing recommendation letters and to admission offices of the School of Business and Engineering.

If you think you see incidents of misconduct, you should tell your instructor about them, in which case they will take appropriate action and protect your identity. You could also choose to contact our administrator Tammy Herbst -Koel (therbst@wisc.edu) and your identity will be kept confidential.

For more information, refer to <https://www.students.wisc.edu/doso/academic-integrity/>

Grievance Procedure

The Department of Economics has developed a grievance procedure through which you may register comments or complaints about a course, an instructor, or a teaching assistant. The Department continues to provide a course evaluation each semester in every class. If you wish to make anonymous complaints to an instructor or teaching assistant, the appropriate vehicle is the course evaluation. If you have a disagreement with an instructor or a teaching assistant, we strongly encourage you to try to resolve the dispute with him or her directly. The grievance procedure is designed for situations where neither of these channels is appropriate.

If you wish to file a grievance, you should go to room 7238 Social Science and request a Course Comment Sheet. When completing the comment sheet, you will need to provide a detailed statement that describes what aspects of the course you find unsatisfactory. You will need to sign the sheet and provide your student identification number, your address, and a phone where you can be reached. The Department plans to investigate comments fully and will respond in writing to complaints.

Your name, address, phone number, and student ID number will not be revealed to the instructor or teaching assistant involved and will be treated as confidential. The Department needs this information, because it may become necessary for a commenting student to have a meeting with the department chair or a nominee to gather additional information. A name and address are necessary for providing a written response.

STUDENTS' RULES, [RIGHTS & RESPONSIBILITIES](#)

UW-MADISON [BADGER PLEDGE](#)